

THE FINNS ABROAD

SPRING 2027

A LONG WEEKEND · EARLY MAY BANK HOLIDAY

Amsterdam

Three nights on the Amstel: Rembrandt and Van Gogh, a private boat on the canals, Keukenhof's tulips at their peak, and dinner in a glasshouse.

WHEN	WHO	STAYING	GETTING THERE
Fri 30 April – Mon 3 May 2027	Andy & Marta	Tivoli Doelen Amsterdam	KLM, Europe Business

The idea

A culture weekend, *done easily*

An hour and a quarter from Heathrow, Amsterdam is ideal for a bank-holiday escape. We stay right on the Amstel, in the old centre, so the canals, Dam Square and the Nine Streets are on the doorstep and the great museums are a short walk or tram ride away. Everything is timed to miss the queues: a private guide at the Rijksmuseum, first slots at Anne Frank House, a chauffeured run to Keukenhof and our own boat on the canals.

3	1	6	3	18°
NIGHTS	DAY OF LEAVE	EXPERIENCES	DINNERS	TYPICAL HIGH

Getting there

Flights, *door to door*

OUTBOUND · FRIDAY 30 APRIL

08:40 LHR · T4 → 11:00 AMS

KLM KL1002 · Europe Business · SkyTeam lounge at Terminal 4. Private car from Schiphol to the hotel, about 25–30 minutes.

RETURN · MONDAY 3 MAY (UK BANK HOLIDAY)

17:45 AMS → 18:05 LHR · T4

KLM KL1021 · Europe Business · home for supper on the bank holiday.

Flight times are from KLM's usual schedule for these days and will be confirmed when we book. Parker Cars to and from Heathrow.

Where we're staying

Tivoli *Doelen*



ON THE AMSTEL, BY THE MUNTTOREN



DELUXE ROOM, CANAL VIEW



THE CANAL RING ON THE DOORSTEP

OLD CENTRE · THREE NIGHTS

One of Amsterdam's oldest hotels, right on the water

The Doelen has stood on the Amstel since the 1880s, on the site of the old civic guard's headquarters where Rembrandt's Night Watch first hung. Restored by Tivoli, it keeps the domed corner tower, the canal-side terrace and rooms looking over the river.

From here you can walk to Dam Square, the Royal Palace, the flower market and the Nine Streets. The museum quarter is 15–20 minutes away on foot, or a few stops on tram 2 or 12.

ROOM	Deluxe room with canal view, king bed
ADDRESS	Nieuwe Doelenstraat 24, 1012 CP Amsterdam
EXTRAS	Canal-side terrace, river views, a short walk to everything

HOTEL WEBSITE ↗ THE ROOMS ↗ MAP ↗ TELEGRAPH REVIEW ↗

Day by day

The *weekend*

30
FRIDAY · APRIL

Arrival, the canals and dinner in a glasshouse



08:40	KLM KL1002 from Heathrow T4, landing 11:00. Car waiting at Schiphol.
11:45	Check in to **Tivoli Doelen** (early check-in if the room is ready) and drop the bags.
13:00	Lunch nearby, then a gentle stroll along the Amstel and the flower market.
16:30	**Private salon boat** with champagne, from the jetty three minutes from the hotel: 90 minutes through the Golden Bend and the Jordaan.
18:45	Taxi (12 minutes) to **Restaurant De Kas**, a set menu in a glasshouse in Frankendael Park, cooked from its own gardens.

01
SATURDAY · MAY

Rembrandt, Vermeer and Van Gogh



09:00	Breakfast at the hotel.
10:00	**Rijksmuseum** with a private art historian: the Gallery of Honour, the Night Watch and Vermeer's Milkmaid. A 17-minute walk.
13:00	Lunch near Museumplein.
14:30	**Van Gogh Museum** on a timed slot: Sunflowers, the Potato Eaters and the self-portraits.
17:00	Tram back to the hotel for a rest.
19:30	Dinner at **Rijks** (one Michelin star), modern Dutch cooking in the Rijksmuseum's garden wing.

02

SUNDAY · MAY

Tulips at their peak and the Royal Palace

07:30	Chauffeured car to **Keukenhof** (45 minutes), arriving soon after the 08:00 opening, ahead of the coaches.
08:15	Seven million bulbs in the park's final fortnight, with a detour through the flowering bulb fields.
12:30	Back to Amsterdam for a late lunch.
15:00	The **Royal Palace** on Dam Square and its marble Citizens' Hall, a 10-minute walk.
19:30	Dinner at **Moeders** in the Jordaan, proper Dutch cooking in a much-loved local institution.



03

MONDAY · MAY

Anne Frank, the Nine Streets and home

08:00	Breakfast and check-out; the hotel keeps our bags.
09:00	**Anne Frank House** on the first slot of the day, with the introductory talk. An 18-minute walk along the canals.
11:00	Coffee and a wander through the Nine Streets.
13:00	Light lunch near the hotel.
15:30	Car to Schiphol, then the lounge.
17:45	KLM KL1021 to Heathrow, landing 18:05.



The map

Getting *around*



Times are from the hotel. Most of the city is walkable; trams 2 and 12 run to the museums, and Uber, Bolt or a TCA taxi covers the rest.

H Tivoli Doelen
Base

1 Rijksmuseum
17 min walk

2 Van Gogh Museum
12 min by tram 2 or 12

3 Anne Frank House
18 min walk

4 Canal cruise boarding
3 min walk, Amstel jetty

5 Royal Palace
10 min walk up Rokin

6 Rijks
18 min walk or 10 min taxi

7 Moeders
20 min walk or 10 min taxi

8 Restaurant De Kas
12 min by taxi, Frankendael Park (off the map, east)

9 Keukenhof
45 min by private car, Lisse

What we'll see

Six *experiences*



SATURDAY MORNING

Rijksmuseum

The Dutch national museum: Rembrandt's Night Watch, Vermeer, Frans Hals and the Gallery of Honour.

Private art-historian guide, two hours.

OFFICIAL SITE ↗



FRIDAY AFTERNOON

Private canal cruise

The UNESCO-listed canal ring from the water: the Herengracht's Golden Bend, the bridges and the Jordaan.

Classic salon boat with a skipper and drinks, boarding by the hotel.

OPERATORS ↗



SUNDAY MORNING

Keukenhof

The world's great spring garden in its final fortnight: lakes, woodland and rivers of tulips. Open until 9 May.

Chauffeured, arriving at opening; back by lunch.

OFFICIAL SITE ↗



SATURDAY AFTERNOON

Van Gogh Museum

The world's largest Van Gogh collection, with Sunflowers, the Potato Eaters, self-portraits and letters.

Timed entry, booked online.

OFFICIAL SITE ↗



MONDAY MORNING

Anne Frank House

The preserved Secret Annex where Anne Frank hid and wrote her diary, from 1942 to 1944.

Tickets are released about six weeks ahead, on the official site only.

OFFICIAL SITE ↗



SUNDAY AFTERNOON

Royal Palace

The Golden Age town hall on Dam Square, with its spectacular marble Citizens' Hall.

Multimedia guide; we'll check it isn't closed for a royal event.

OFFICIAL SITE ↗

Where we'll eat

Three *dinners*



FRIDAY · MICHELIN GREEN STAR

Restaurant De Kas

A set menu served in a 1926 municipal greenhouse in Frankendael Park, built around what's growing in its own gardens that week.

Kamerlingh Onneslaan 3 · closed Sundays

MENU ↗ WINE LIST ↗ MICHELIN REVIEW ↗ DIRECTIONS ↗



SATURDAY · ONE MICHELIN STAR

Rijks

Joris Bijdendijk's modern Dutch cooking in the Rijksmuseum's garden wing, built on produce and the Golden Age spice trade.

Museumstraat 2 · dinner Mon–Sat

MENU ↗ WINE LIST ↗ REVIEW ↗ DIRECTIONS ↗



SUNDAY · LOCAL INSTITUTION

Moeders

A Jordaan favourite, its walls covered in diners' photos of their mothers. Hearty stamppot and the Dutch classics, in a cheerful room.

Rozengracht 251 · open daily from 17:00

MENU ↗ WINE LIST ↗ REVIEW ↗ DIRECTIONS ↗

Good to know

The *practical* bits

Weather

Early May typically brings highs of around 18° and lows near 8°, long light evenings, and a chance of showers. Pack layers and a light raincoat.

Money

Euros. Contactless cards and Apple Pay work almost everywhere, including trams; Amsterdam is close to cashless. No special payment apps needed.

Taxis

Uber and Bolt both work well. For a classic cab, TCA (Taxi Centrale Amsterdam); every licensed taxi must take cards.

Say it in Dutch

Please: **alstublieft** (AHL-stuu-bleeft) · Thank you: **dank u wel** (DAHNK uu vel) · Hello: **hallo**. Almost everyone speaks excellent English.

Holidays

King's Day is the Tuesday before (27 April). We fly home on the UK bank holiday, Monday 3 May. Remembrance Day (4 May) and Liberation Day (5 May) follow just after.

What's on

The Music On festival takes over part of the city on 1–2 May, and it's the Dutch May school holiday, so every museum ticket is pre-booked.

Passports

Valid for at least three months beyond our return. On British passports the new EU entry checks apply; we'll check ETIAS before we go.

Plugs & water

European two-pin plugs, so bring adaptors. Tap water is excellent. Watch out for the red bike lanes.

With love, Andy

This is a proposal, so nothing is booked yet. Times and the restaurant line-up may change as bookings open.

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